

To-Do: Rebrand DBA to "Desert Sky Development"

desertskyaz.com → Desert Sky Development · prepared 2026-07-03 · full reasoning in docs/business/DBA-CHANGE.md

Assumptions this list is built on (flag if wrong): single-member Arizona LLC; `desertskyaz.com` is currently a registered AZ trade name; only the trade name is changing, not the LLC's legal name.

Phase 0 — Before filing anything

- ☐ Search the AZ SOS trade name/trademark database (azsos.gov/business/tntm) for "Desert Sky Development" and close variants — confirm it's available.
- ☐ Quick search on USPTO TESS (tmsearch.uspto.gov) for the same name, to avoid an existing federal trademark conflict.
- ☐ Decide the exact legal spelling/capitalization: "Desert Sky Development" vs "Desert Sky Development LLC" vs a stylized d/b/a — pick one and use it everywhere below.

Phase 1 — State of Arizona filings

- ☐ File the new trade name "Desert Sky Development" with the Arizona Secretary of State (azsos.gov/business/tntm). Cost: \$10 (+\$25 optional expedite).
- ☐ Once approved, let the old `desertskyaz.com` trade name lapse or cancel it — don't cancel before the new one is approved.
- ☐ If an Arizona TPT (sales tax) license is active: [AZTaxes.gov](https://aztaxes.gov) → Account Update, change the DBA field. Cost: \$12/location + any city fee. Skip if no TPT license on file.
- ☐ If the business holds a city business license, check that city's portal for a name-update requirement.

Phase 2 — Federal

- ☐ Nothing to file with the IRS — a DBA-only change doesn't require a new EIN or IRS notice.
- ☐ Reissue Form W-9 to clients/platforms with one on file: Line 1 = LLC's legal name (unchanged), Line 2 = "Desert Sky Development."
- ☐ If registered in SAM.gov for federal contract work, update the DBA field there too (skip if not applicable).

Phase 3 — Banking & money

- ☐ Bring the approved AZ trade name certificate to the bank to update the DBA on the business account.
- ☐ Update the business name/DBA in Stripe, PayPal, Square, or other payment processors.
- ☐ Update accounting software (QuickBooks, Wave, etc.) — both "legal name" and "DBA/display name" fields.
- ☐ Update the name on record with any business insurance policy, if one exists.

Phase 4 — Contracts & clients

- ☐ Send the client/vendor notification (template below).
- ☐ For active contracts referencing "desertskyaz.com" by name, decide: formal amendment/addendum vs. simple notice.
- ☐ Update invoice/proposal templates to show the new name.

Phase 5 — Web & digital presence

- ☐ Update website copy, header/footer, and title/meta tags (the domain can stay desertskyaz.com — it doesn't need to match the trade name).
- ☐ Update Google Business Profile name.
- ☐ Update LinkedIn, GitHub org/profile, and other social/dev-facing profiles.
- ☐ Update email signature(s).
- ☐ Update project repos: README, package.json/pyproject author fields, LICENSE copyright lines, etc.

Phase 6 — Physical / misc

- ☐ Business cards, letterhead, signage.
- ☐ Update the DBA name with any professional associations or directories.

Copy-paste: client/vendor notification email

Subject: Business name update – desertskyaz.com is now Desert Sky Development

Hi [Name],

Quick note: I've updated my business's DBA (trade name) from "desertskyaz.com" to Desert Sky Development, effective [date]. This better reflects the software development work we do together – nothing else is changing: same LLC, same EIN, same point of contact, same ongoing work.

You'll start seeing "Desert Sky Development" on invoices, contracts, and any new paperwork going forward. Let me know if you need an updated W-9 or anything else on file for your records.

Thanks,
[Your name]

Copy-paste: short brand-update blurb (website / social)

desertskyaz.com is now Desert Sky Development – same team, same work, a name that actually says what we do: software development.

Copy-paste: W-9 note

Line 1 (legal name): [LLC legal name – unchanged]
Line 2 (DBA/business name): Desert Sky Development